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Final pitches in Maine contest

Jackson, Collins battle to the end in Senate race

By Sam Brodey
GLOBE STAFF

PORTLAND, Maine — The sight was a metaphor for the final days of Maine's US Senate race: Troy Jackson, at a Halloween campaign photo-op, dressed as an attack ad.

Accompanied by his family on Saturday in downtown Portland, the Democratic candidate — wearing a brown shirt festooned with cutouts of logs — was a "cord of wood," a not-so-subtle jab at a TV ad from his opponent, Republican Senator Susan Collins, which suggested the former logger was not qualified for the job he is seeking.

There's no question that the clash between Collins and Jackson, two longtime fixtures of Maine politics, has grown unavoidably personal in its closing stretch. Both sides are litigating attacks, slights, and counterattacks from the candidates themselves as well as the myriad of outside players with an interest in the race.

Still, the closing messages of each campaign have landed in predictable places, even for a Senate contest that has been defined by its dramatic unpredictability since a little-known oysterman entered the race last summer.

Jackson and his Democratic

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DANIELLE PARHIZKARAN/GLOBE STAFF

Supporters offered a variety of signs during a get-out-the-vote rally for Massachusetts Democrats Monday at Hibernian Hall in Boston.

Any blue wave would ripple into Mass. politics

Delegation members poised for powerful posts

By Samantha J. Gross
GLOBE STAFF

PLYMOUTH — Speaking against the backdrop of a full-scale replica of the Mayflower, US Representative Bill Keating tapped into the motivations of the 17th-century Pilgrims in framing Tuesday's election. Those Puritans fled a church they considered to be corrupt, he said, and believed it's the people who should "make decisions."

"Not the king, not the monarch, but the people," Keating told a crowd of roughly 100 people who gathered at Pilgrim Memorial State Park on Sunday. Come Tuesday, he said, "we are going to win and take back our government."

Indeed, Democrats are brimming with confidence that Tuesday's election can produce the wave election they're envisioning to return their party to power on Capitol Hill. And even in Massachusetts, where they hold every statewide elected office, a super-majority in the state Legislature, and every seat of the

BLUE WAVE, Page A6



Questions of the day

How should you vote on each ballot measure? Read our guide to what 'yes' and 'no' mean.

GLOBE STAFF

When Massachusetts voters head to the polls Tuesday, they will find a whopping nine statewide questions on the ballot — and just as much at stake.

From forcing more transparency by state lawmakers to deciding whether to keep marijuana legal, the ballot measures, taken together, hand voters the power to radically reshape the state.

This year's slate of ballot questions is the busiest the state has seen in more than three decades. But the language in which the measures are written is often dense, and outside groups are pushing their own spin on TV and in your inbox.

We've boiled down all nine to just a sentence or two of plain English, distilling what a "yes" or "no" vote would mean on each to help you make sense of thorny decisions.

Read it and take it with you to the voting booth.

ILLUSTRATION BY LUIS G. RENDON/GLOBE STAFF; ADOBE

Question 1 deals with the state's public records law. Unlike most states, the Massachusetts governor's office and Legislature have claimed blanket exemptions from following the law allowing the public to access government records.

A yes vote would expand the current public records law to cover most records held by the Legislature and governor's office.

A no vote would leave the state's public records law unchanged.

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Question 2 asks whether state public defenders and other employees at the Committee for Public Counsel Services should be given the ability to form a union.

A yes vote would give CPCS employees the opportunity to unionize.

A no vote would keep the law as it is.

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DAVID L. RYAN/GLOBE STAFF

Voting guide
What to know before you head to the polls. **B4.**

US Senate power
Results could yield a narrow majority for either party, or even a 50-50 tie. **A7.**

'Progressive agenda'
US Senator Ed Markey of Massachusetts has taken a more visible role in the Democratic Party's left wing. **B1.**

Strolls to the polls

Tuesday: Sun through clouds. High 68-73. Low 53-58.
Wednesday: Sunny and warm. High 70-75. Low 55-60.
Sunrise: 6:20 Sunset: 4:35

Obituaries, **C8-9**
Comics and Weather, **D5-6**

The US struck Iranian targets in the Strait of Hormuz, after Tehran said it would reopen the passage under conditions. **A4.**

Lindsay Clancy's lawyer called for a decision on a retrial from the district attorney. **B1.**

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A triple strike threat at Harvard

3 unions, 7,000 workers could walk out at once

By Katie Johnston and Michaela Towfighi
GLOBE STAFF

With more than 24,000 students spread out across 14 schools and hundreds of acres, Harvard University is many things to many people. But one common thread, at least among its workers, is inequity.

Dolores Perez makes $28 an hour as a pot washer in Harvard University's dining halls. Adjusted for inflation, it's less than his starting wage there more than 20 years ago.

Denish Jaswal, a Harvard PhD student, earned half as much while employed part-time as a teaching fellow as other graduate students who held research assistant positions.

Allie Stanton, a postdoc at Harvard Medical School, said fellow researchers and nontenure-track faculty with children have to spend as much as three-quarters of their salary on day care costs, while Harvard offers higher-paid tenured professors substantially more financial assistance.

The three are among more than 7,000 Harvard workers already on strike or threatening to walk off the job as the world's richest university tightens its purse strings in the midst of financial uncertainty and political turmoil. The grad students launched their strike last Tuesday — their second action of the year — and researchers and nontenure-track teachers set a deadline of Nov.

HARVARD, Page A10



SUZANNE KREITER/GLOBE STAFF

Harvard graduate students went on strike last week.

City adds to list of proposed school closings

Greater Egleston, center for early education included

By John Hilliard
GLOBE STAFF

Mayor Michelle Wu's administration on Monday proposed shutting two high schools and an early education center as part of the latest round of Boston school closures while enrollment continues to fall because of low birthrates and a decline in immigration.

The proposed closures, which would occur in June 2028, would impact Charlestown and Greater Egleston high schools, along with the East Boston Early Education Center, Wu said. The school buildings can accommodate far more students than they currently enroll, according to data released by Boston Public Schools.

In Charlestown, administrators plan to move a different high school into the Charlestown High building by fall 2028, Wu said, so it does not sit empty. The broader reorganization, she said, will

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